

Peer Review Worksheet for Argumentative Writing

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Research Paper Title: The Legalization of recreational use cannabis is beneficial

Directions

- Complete this worksheet to receive 2 points.
- Submit photos (scans or documents are also acceptable) to Blackboard of the detailed proofreading/editing that you write on the author's research paper to receive an additional 2 points. If the author does not have any mistakes, you can at least write one or two sentences of feedback for every paragraph instead of editing.

Quick check

1. Has the author completed the Generative AI Use Statement? (You need to ask.) Yes, he has
2. How many pages long is the research paper? 5 pages long, excluding two reference pages
3. Does it have a Cover Page and a References Page? ~~Yes~~ No cover page / Have reference page
4. How many paragraphs does the research paper have? Does it include an introduction, a body with a few supporting body paragraphs and one refutation (counterarguments/rebuttal) paragraph, and a conclusion?
6 paragraphs. Yes, it does.

Introduction

1. Locate these items:
 - Hook: Put brackets [] around it and mark *Hook* in the left margin
 - Background information: Put brackets [] around it and mark *Background* in the left margin
 - A clear thesis statement: underline it

2. Comments

- Does the introduction provide sufficient background information so unfamiliar readers can still follow the argument? If not, what else could be shared?

Yes, he showed the gradual legalization of cannabis and harm of cannabis. ~~He~~

- Does the introduction contain a clearly stated thesis statement (an arguable statement that the writing will prove)? If not, suggest how the thesis statement could be rewritten. *However, some arguments need more data to support.*
Yes, it does. "legalization" is beneficial

Supporting Body Paragraphs

1. Locate these items

- Topic sentences: underline them
- Transitional words and phrases in topic sentences: circle them

2. Comments

- Are there at least two supporting body paragraphs? Yes, at least 2, he has three
- Does each paragraph have at least 5 sentences or does the author have unnecessary paragraph separation? Yes, the three all have at least 5 sentences.

and he did not add unnecessary paragraph separation

Refutation (Counterarguments/Rebuttal) Paragraph

1. Locate these items

- Counterargument: underline it



- Rebuttal: put brackets [] around it and mark *Rebuttal* in the left margin
- Transitional words and phrases: circle them

2. Comments

- Does the author examine at least one counterargument? Is the argument actually against the thesis? If not, what could be a possible counterargument?

Yes, the counterargument really matches. Yes. Cannabis does bad for society/people

- If the author does have a counterargument, does the author actually respond to (refute) the counterargument, or does the author just give another supporting reason for the thesis? What could the author say to improve the response to counterargument? *real data*

Yes, he does. Provide some professional support for legalization

- Does the author provide enough supporting details, examples, or evidence in the counterargument paragraph to show that the counterargument is weak, and therefore, reinforces the thesis (also known as refutation or a rebuttal)?

Yes, he does. Maybe it would be good to use more recent examples

Conclusion

1. Locate these items

data/research

- Restated thesis: underline it
- Summary of main points: put brackets [] around it and mark *Summary* in the left margin
- Closing thoughts: put brackets [] around it and mark *Closing* in the left margin
- Transitional words and phrases: circle them

2. Comments

- Does the conclusion refer back to the thesis statement? *Yes, he does*
- Does the conclusion use an effective closing strategy or final thought (e.g. making a prediction, quoting an expert, calling to action etc.)? How could the author change the conclusion to convince the reader?

Yes, he does. The conclusion uses the strategy of calling to action

Language Use

1. Locate these items

- Circle any informal or non-academic language use:
 - a. Informal vocabulary or slang
 - b. Contractions (can't, don't, what's, that's, it's, etc.)
 - c. Use of 1st or 2nd person perspective (I, me, my, you, your, us, our, etc.)
 - d. Direct Questions
 - e. Vague/meaningless expressions (In this article, In the essay, The purpose of this paper, etc.)

2. Underline any grammar, punctuation, capitalization, or spelling problems.

Mechanics/Format

1. Check mechanics, including:

- whether the title and headings are capitalized correctly; *Yes*
- whether the first line of each paragraph is indented with 5 spaces; *Yes*
- whether double line space is used throughout the entire manuscript; *Yes*
- whether the font is Times New Roman, 12 point; *Yes*
- whether there is proper punctuation (a space after periods and commas); *Yes*
- Circle any problems mentioned above.

2. Comments

- Are paragraphs aligned to the left? ✓

Yes, he did the 'aligned to the left'



- Are titles and headings centered? *Yes, they are centered*

References and Citations

1. Locate these items

- Circle each in-text citation in research paper. Can you locate each of them in full detail on the References Page? *Yes, I can.*

2. Comments

- Do the in-text citations and references follow APA format? If not, please underline the parts that need revising and write a brief summary of the problems (e.g. In-text citations: no page number is added in a quotation.)

Yes, it follows the APA format

- Are there at least four academic references from four different publications on References Page? (three should come from academic journals).

Yes, there are

- Are all References listed in English?

Yes, all references are listed in English

- How many direct quotes are used and cited? (three is the maximum number of direct quotes allowed, but none are actually required.)

None. He did not do the direct quotes

- Is there at least one in-text citation in the introduction and each supporting body paragraph?

Yes, he did

- Are there two in-text citations in the refutation (counterarguments/rebuttal) paragraph?

Yes, there are

Overall Comment

What is your overall impression about the research paper?

(Write at least two complete sentences.)

The language of this research paper is so standardized, there is almost no colloquial expression. It presents a compelling case for the legalization of recreational cannabis and uses strong evidence/data.

Did the author write a formal, argumentative research paper about an important, controversial topic?

(Write at least two complete sentences.)

Yes, the author really wrote a formal, argumentative research paper addressing the controversial topic of recreational cannabis legalization. The paper presents a well-structured argument supported by substantial evidence, advocating for the benefits of legalization in reducing crime, boosting the economy, and enhancing the public health.

